

CITIZENSHIP

MEMBERSHIP → ARTICLES 5-11 → ACQUISITION → LOSS → SECTION 6A → OCI/CAA → 2026 PROCEDURE → PYQS → ANSWER SPINE → VERDICT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g15 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

CITIZENSHIP: MEMBERSHIP, RIGHTS AND SINGLE NATIONAL STATUS

MEMBERSHIP, RIGHTS AND SINGLE NATIONAL STATUS

PERSON WITHIN INDIA

+++ POLITICAL MEMBERSHIP OF INDIA

+++ CITIZEN-ONLY RIGHTS

ARTICLES 15, 16, 19, 29 AND 30

+++ ELIGIBILITY FOR SPECIFIED CONSTITUTIONAL OFFICES

ALIEN PERSON-BASED GUARANTEES INCLUDE ARTICLES 14, 20 AND 21

PERMANENT LEGAL HOME PLUS INTENTION

PERSON WITHIN INDIA

+++ political membership of India

+++ citizen-only rights: Articles 15, 16, 19 and 29; Article 30 says minorities

+++ eligibility for specified constitutional offices

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PERSON WITHIN INDIA
- +++ political membership of India
- +++ citizen-only rights: Articles 15, 16, 19 and 29; Article 30 says minorities

POWER / PROCEDURE

- +++ eligibility for specified constitutional offices
- ALIEN person-based guarantees include Articles 14, 20 and 21 may be foreign national or stateless person
- DOMICILE = permanent legal home plus intention

CHECK / LIMIT

- RESIDENCE = factual presence under a specified rule
- CITIZENSHIP = legal-political membership
- SINGLE CITIZENSHIP → national equality of membership across Union and States

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- +++ eligibility for specified constitutional offices

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Citizenship is the legally recognised membership of the Indian political community: it links allegiance and protection, allocates political voice and selected public offices, and remains principally statutory after the Constitution's commencement settlement.

01

STAGE 01

ARTICLES 5-7: COMMENCEMENT CITIZENSHIP DECISION TREE

ARTICLES 5-7

COMMENCEMENT CITIZENSHIP DECISION TREE

AT COMMENCEMENT, 26 JAN 1950

ARTICLE 5

DOMICILE IN INDIA + ONE CONNECTION BIRTH IN INDIA

PARENT BORN IN INDIA

FIVE YEARS' ORDINARY RESIDENCE

ARTICLE 6

AT COMMENCEMENT, 26 JAN 1950

ARTICLE 5: domicile in India + one connection birth in India

parent born in India

five years' ordinary residence

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- AT COMMENCEMENT, 26 JAN 1950
- ARTICLE 5: domicile in India + one connection birth in India

POWER / PROCEDURE

- parent born in India
- five years' ordinary residence

CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 6: migrated from Pakistan to India before 19 Jul 1948 → ordinary-residence route on/after 19 Jul 1948
- registration after permit-era conditions

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 7: migrated to Pakistan after 1 Mar 1947 generally excluded permit for resettlement/permanent return may restore Article 6 route
- Five-year residence alone never satisfied Article 5; domicile remained essential.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Articles 5-8 identified citizens at commencement, Article 9 disqualified voluntary foreign citizenship for the specified commencement routes, Article 10 continued status subject to law, and Article 11 empowered Parliament to build the permanent statutory regime.

02

STAGE 02

ARTICLES 8-11: OVERSEAS ORIGIN, CONTINUITY AND PARLIAMENT

ARTICLES 8-11

OVERSEAS ORIGIN, CONTINUITY AND PARLIAMENT

ARTICLE 8

INDIAN ORIGIN ABROAD + REGISTRATION BY INDIAN DIPLOMATIC OR

ARTICLE 9 VOLUNTARY FOREIGN CITIZENSHIP BLOCKS ARTICLES 5, 6

ARTICLE 10 COMMENCEMENT CITIZENSHIP CONTINUES SUBJECT TO PARLIAMENTARY LAW

ARTICLE 11

PARLIAMENT REGULATES ACQUISITION, TERMINATION AND ALL CITIZENSHIP MATTERS

ARTICLE 8

Indian origin abroad + registration by Indian diplomatic or consular officer

ARTICLE 9 voluntary foreign citizenship blocks Articles 5, 6 and 8 claim

ARTICLE 10 commencement citizenship continues subject to parliamentary law

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 8
- Indian origin abroad + registration by Indian diplomatic or consular officer

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ARTICLE 9 voluntary foreign citizenship blocks Articles 5, 6 and 8 claim
- ARTICLE 10 commencement citizenship continues subject to parliamentary law

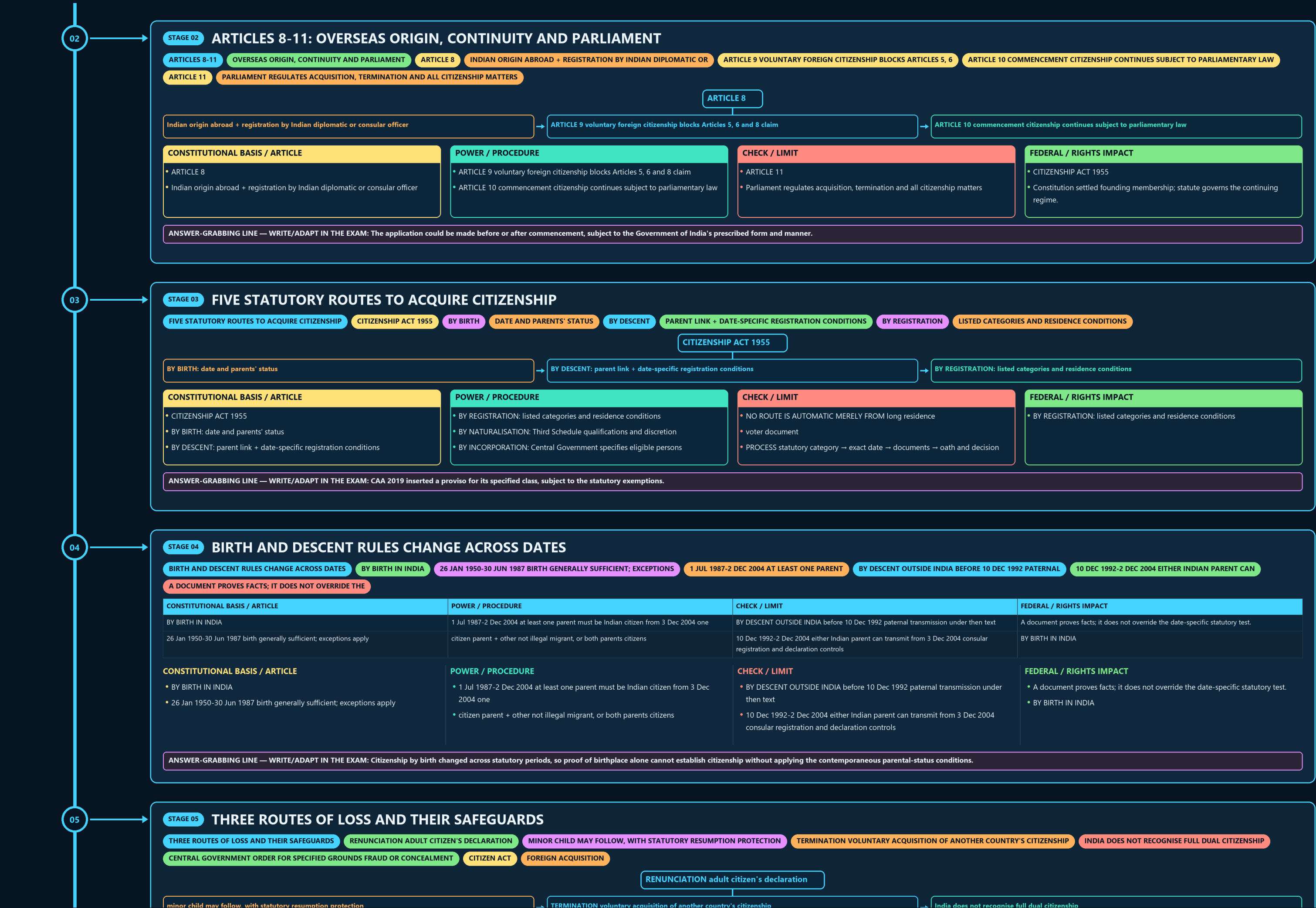
CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 11
- Parliament regulates acquisition, termination and all citizenship matters

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- CITIZENSHIP ACT 1955
- Constitution settled founding membership; statute governs the continuing regime.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The application could be made before or after commencement, subject to the Government of India's prescribed form and manner.



05

STAGE 05

THREE ROUTES OF LOSS AND THEIR SAFEGUARDS

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RENUNCIATION ADULT CITIZEN'S DECLARATION

MINOR CHILD MAY FOLLOW, WITH STATUTORY RESUMPTION PROTECTION

TERMINATION VOLUNTARY ACQUISITION OF ANOTHER COUNTRY'S CITIZENSHIP

INDIA DOES NOT RECOGNISE FULL DUAL CITIZENSHIP

CENTRAL GOVERNMENT ORDER FOR SPECIFIED GROUNDS FRAUD OR CONCEALMENT

CITIZEN ACT

FOREIGN ACQUISITION

RENUNCIATION adult citizen's declaration

minor child may follow, with statutory resumption protection

TERMINATION voluntary acquisition of another country's citizenship

India does not recognise full dual citizenship

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- RENUNCIATION adult citizen's declaration
- minor child may follow, with statutory resumption protection

POWER / PROCEDURE

- TERMINATION voluntary acquisition of another country's citizenship
- India does not recognise full dual citizenship

CHECK / LIMIT

- Central Government order for specified grounds fraud or concealment disloyalty or unlawful enemy dealing specified conviction or residence
- conditions notice, inquiry and public-good control renunciation = citizen act

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- termination = foreign acquisition
- deprivation = State order

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The common shorthand "deprivation applies to registered and naturalised citizens" is incomplete because the Act contains express inclusions and exclusions.

06

STAGE 06

ASSAM SECTION 6A: CUT-OFFS, CONSEQUENCES AND JUDICIAL CONTROL

ASSAM SECTION 6A

CUT-OFFS, CONSEQUENCES AND JUDICIAL CONTROL

ASSAM-SPECIFIC SECTION 6A ENTERED BEFORE 1 JAN 1966 DEEMED

NRC USES 24 MARCH 1971 MIDNIGHT AS ASSAM'S CUT-OFF

IN RE

IN RE: SECTION 6A (2024) — 17 OCTOBER

1 JUDGMENT UPHOLDS SECTION 6A: IMPLEMENTATION REMAINS CRUCIAL.

NATIONAL MEMBERSHIP + ASSAM MIGRATION HISTORY + CULTURAL PROTECTION.

ASSAM-SPECIFIC SECTION 6A entered before 1 Jan 1966 deemed citizens under statutory scheme entered 1

Mar 1971 detection + registration ten-year electoral-roll exclusion entered on/after 25 Mar 1971 no Section

NRC uses 24 March 1971 midnight as Assam's cut-off reference.

IN RE: SECTION 6A (2024) — 17 OCTOBER

4:1 judgment upholds Section 6A; implementation remains crucial.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ASSAM-SPECIFIC SECTION 6A entered before 1 Jan 1966 deemed citizens under statutory scheme entered 1 Jan 1966-before 25
- Mar 1971 detection + registration ten-year electoral-roll exclusion entered on/after 25 Mar 1971 no Section 6A protection

POWER / PROCEDURE

- NRC uses 24 March 1971 midnight as Assam's cut-off reference.
- IN RE: SECTION 6A (2024) — 17 OCTOBER

CHECK / LIMIT

- 4:1 judgment upholds Section 6A; implementation remains crucial.
- TENSION: national membership + Assam migration history + cultural protection.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ASSAM-SPECIFIC SECTION 6A entered before 1 Jan 1966 deemed citizens under statutory scheme entered 1 Jan 1966-before 25
- Mar 1971 detection + registration ten-year electoral-roll exclusion entered on/after 25 Mar 1971 no Section 6A protection

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Section 6A creates an Assam-specific citizenship settlement with differentiated cut-offs, but it confers Indian citizenship rather than any separate Assam citizenship.

07

STAGE 07

OCI AND CAA: CONNECTION IS NOT CITIZENSHIP

OCI AND CAA

CONNECTION IS NOT CITIZENSHIP

OCI LIFELONG VISA-RELATED AND NOTIFIED BENEFITS NOT DUAL CITIZENSHIP

CAA FACILITATION SIX COMMUNITIES

HINDU, SIKH, BUDDHIST, JAIN, PARSİ, CHRISTIAN THREE COUNTRIES

AFGHANISTAN, BANGLADESH, PAKISTAN ENTRY

ON OR BEFORE 31 DEC 2014 SPECIFIED IMMIGRATION EXEMPTION

FIVE INSTEAD OF ELEVEN YEARS FOR SPECIFIED CLASS TERRITORIAL

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
OCI lifelong visa-related and notified benefits not dual citizenship; no vote or constitutional-office entitlement	before 31 Dec 2014 specified immigration exemption + application conditions naturalisation aggregate: five instead of eleven years for	ARTICLE 14 DEBATE	Challenge: religion/country exclusions, under-inclusion, secularism and Assam impact
CAA FACILITATION six communities: Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi, Christian three countries: Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Pakistan entry: on or	specified class territorial exclusions apply	State: neighbouring theocracies, minorities and humanitarian classification	SOURCE STATUS: 2019 Act and 2024 Rules operative; no located final merits judgment.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- OCI lifelong visa-related and notified benefits not dual citizenship; no vote or constitutional-office entitlement
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POWER / PROCEDURE

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- specified class territorial exclusions apply

CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 14 DEBATE
- State: neighbouring theocracies, minorities and humanitarian classification

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Challenge: religion/country exclusions, under-inclusion, secularism and Assam impact
- SOURCE STATUS: 2019 Act and 2024 Rules operative; no located final merits judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The 19 August 2026 Collector route changes Section 6B administration for specified territories; it does not change the CAA eligibility class or 31 December 2014 cut-off.

07

STAGE 07

OCI AND CAA: CONNECTION IS NOT CITIZENSHIP

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POWER / PROCEDURE

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specified class territorial exclusions apply

CHECK / LIMIT

ARTICLE 14 DEBATE

State: neighbouring theocracies, minorities and humanitarian classification

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Challenge: religion/country exclusions, under-inclusion, secularism and Assam impact

SOURCE STATUS: 2019 Act and 2024 Rules operative; no located final merits judgment.

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08

STAGE 08

DOCUMENT PROOF AND EXACT PRELIMS PYQ CONTROLS

AADHAAR ≠ CITIZENSHIP PROOF

2018 Q12: NEITHER 1 NOR 2

2021 Q89: 1 ONLY

PASSPORT / EPIC: EVIDENCE, NOT UNIVERSAL CONCLUSIVE PROOF

CONTROL	EXAM USE
Aadhaar	not citizenship proof
2021 Q89	1 only; key provenance qualified

RULE / EVIDENCE

Aadhaar does not by itself prove citizenship or domicile

2018 GS-I Q12 tests proof and deactivation

EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT

2021 GS-I Q89 tests one citizenship/domicile, President and deprivation

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A document may evidence identity, entry or residence, but only the governing constitutional or statutory rule determines citizenship.

09

STAGE 09

2025 OCI CANCELLATION AND 2026 SECTION 6B PROCEDURE

SECTION 7D(DA): SERIOUS-CRIMINALITY OCI CANCELLATION GROUND

G.S.R. 742(E): SPECIFIED APPLICANTS APPLY TO COLLECTOR

S.O. 4583(E): PENDING APPLICATIONS TRANSFER TO COLLECTOR

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Section 7D(da): serious-criminality OCI cancellation ground

G.S.R. 742(E): specified applicants apply to Collector

verify documents -> enquiry -> oath -> decision

S.O. 4583(E): pending applications transfer to Collector

RULE / EVIDENCE

Section 7D(da): serious-criminality OCI cancellation ground

G.S.R. 742(E): specified applicants apply to Collector

EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT

verify documents -> enquiry -> oath -> decision

S.O. 4583(E): pending applications transfer to Collector

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCI and CAA remain statutory statuses: current procedure must be stated precisely without converting administrative change into a change of citizenship eligibility.

10

STAGE 10

EXECUTABLE 10 / 15 / 20-MARK ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10: DEFINE + THREE ANCHORS + CAVEAT + VERDICT

15: CONSTITUTIONAL SCHEME + STATUTE + JUDGMENT/DEBATE

SPECIFIC IMPROVEMENT FOLLOWS EVERY SOLVED ANSWER

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10: define + three anchors + caveat + verdict

15: constitutional scheme + statute + judgment/debate

20: both sides + named evidence + 2026 status + safeguards

specific improvement follows every solved answer

CITIZENSHIP • TILE 4/5 • same master rows 6951-10185 of 12502 • continues below

RULE / EVIDENCE • Section 7D(da): serious-criminality OCI cancellation ground • G.S.R. 742(E): specified applicants apply to Collector	EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT • verify documents -> enquiry -> oath -> decision • S.O. 4583(E): pending applications transfer to Collector
MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.	
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OCI and CAA remain statutory statuses: current procedure must be stated precisely without converting administrative change into a change of citizenship eligibility.	

STAGE 10 EXECUTABLE 10 / 15 / 20-MARK ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10: DEFINE + THREE ANCHORS + CAVEAT + VERDICT 15: CONSTITUTIONAL SCHEME + STATUTE + JUDGMENT/DEBATE SPECIFIC IMPROVEMENT FOLLOWS EVERY SOLVED ANSWER SPECIFIC IMPROVEMENT FOLLOWS EVERY SOLVED ANSWER

10: define + three anchors + caveat + verdict

15: constitutional scheme + statute + judgment/debate → 20: both sides + named evidence + 2026 status + safeguards → specific improvement follows every solved answer

RULE / EVIDENCE

- 10: define + three anchors + caveat + verdict
- 15: constitutional scheme + statute + judgment/debate

EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT

- 20: both sides + named evidence + 2026 status + safeguards
- specific improvement follows every solved answer

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A high-scoring citizenship answer separates membership, evidence and procedure, then tests statutory choices against equality, liberty and federal accommodation.

STAGE 11 QUALIFIED SYNTHESIS: LAWFUL MEMBERSHIP UNDER REVIEW

CONSTITUTIONAL FOUNDING SETTLEMENT PARLIAMENTARY STATUTORY ADMINISTRATION EQUAL MEMBERSHIP + LAWFUL CLASSIFICATION + FAIR PROCEDURE EQUAL MEMBERSHIP + LAWFUL CLASSIFICATION + FAIR PROCEDURE

constitutional founding settlement

parliamentary statutory administration → judicial review and natural justice → equal membership + lawful classification + fair procedure

RULE / EVIDENCE

- constitutional founding settlement
- parliamentary statutory administration

EXAM CONTROL / VERDICT

- judicial review and natural justice
- equal membership + lawful classification + fair procedure

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Apply the exact rule, test the evidence and procedure separately, then state a qualified constitutional verdict.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian citizenship law is constitutionally founded, statutorily administered and judicially reviewable; legitimacy depends on equal membership, lawful classification and fair procedure.

EXTRA **SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE**

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

- A. CITIZENSHIP IS A GATEKEEPING STATUS, NOT MERELY A**
- B. FRATERNITY AND EXCLUSION PULL IN OPPOSITE DIRECTIONS**
- C. EQUALITY REVIEW MUST IDENTIFY THE COMPARATOR**
- D. TEMPORAL REASONABLENESS AFTER THE SECTION 6A DISSENT**
- E. NATIONAL MEMBERSHIP AND FEDERAL ASYMMETRY**
- F. OCI AS CALIBRATED EXTERNAL MEMBERSHIP**
- G. POLITICAL THEORY CROSS-LINK - BOUNDED ENRICHMENT ONLY**

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- A. Citizenship is a gatekeeping status, not merely a rights bundle
- B. Fraternity and exclusion pull in opposite directions
- C. Equality review must identify the comparator
- D. Temporal reasonableness after the Section 6A dissent

ADVANCED LIMIT

- E. National membership and federal asymmetry
- F. OCI as calibrated external membership
- G. Political Theory cross-link - bounded enrichment only
- H. A citizenship decision has at least four review layers

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- That is why apparently technical rules about dates and parentage also decide who participates in democratic authorship.
- Fraternity and exclusion pull in opposite directions [ANALYSIS] A citizenship law can advance fraternity by integrating long-settled populations,
- yet weaken it if classification appears to stigmatise another group.
- The Section 6A majority treated historical accommodation as fraternity-consistent

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.